The systematic reviews that informed the formulation of AQG levels and other related evidence discussed during the process are available in a special issue of *Environment International*, entitled *Update of the WHO global air quality guidelines: systematic reviews* (Whaley et al., 2021).

Recommendations on classical air pollutants

In this guideline update, recommendations on AQG levels are formulated, together with interim targets, for the following pollutants: $PM_{2.5}$, PM_{10}, ozone, nitrogen dioxide, sulfur dioxide and carbon monoxide (Table 0.1). The evidence-informed derivation of each AQG level and an indication of the reduction in health risk associated with the achievement of consecutive interim targets can be found in Chapter 3. Only evidence assessed as having high or moderate certainty of an association between a pollutant and a specific health outcome was used to define the recommended AQG levels, and all recommendations are classified as strong according to the adapted Grading of Recommendations Assessment, Development and Evaluation (GRADE) approach (discussed in Chapter 2).

Table 0.1. Recommended AQG levels and interim targets

Pollutant	Averaging time	Interim target				AQG level
		1	2	3	4	
$PM_{2.5}$, µg/m³	Annual	35	25	15	10	5
	24-hour[a]	75	50	37.5	25	15
PM_{10}, µg/m³	Annual	70	50	30	20	15
	24-hour[a]	150	100	75	50	45
O_3, µg/m³	Peak season[b]	100	70	–	–	60
	8-hour[a]	160	120	–	–	100
NO_2, µg/m³	Annual	40	30	20	–	10
	24-hour[a]	120	50	–	–	25
SO_2, µg/m³	24-hour[a]	125	50	–	–	40
CO, mg/m³	24-hour[a]	7	–	–	–	4

[a] 99th percentile (i.e. 3–4 exceedance days per year).
[b] Average of daily maximum 8-hour mean O_3 concentration in the six consecutive months with the highest six-month running-average O_3 concentration.